PayCalc User Guide

Clock in and out, track your pay, and see what is left after bills. Works in the browser on iPhone, Android and desktop.

Site: https://paycalc.work

> **Private by design.** Everything you enter stays in your own browser. There is no account, nothing is sent anywhere, and nobody else can see your numbers. The flip side: your data is not backed up for you. Use **Export JSON** (section 6) every so often.

1. Open it and add it to your device

Open **https://paycalc.work**. You can use it as a normal web page, but adding it to your home screen or desktop makes it one tap away. On the home screen the app may be named **Pay Tracker** (the name you can edit when you add it). Menu names below differ a little between versions and phone makers.

iPhone and iPad

1. Open the site in **Safari**.
2. Tap the **Share** button (the square with an arrow pointing up).
3. Scroll down and tap **Add to Home Screen**.
4. Check the name, then tap **Add**. The icon appears on your home screen.

> **Set up in one place only.** On iPhone, the Safari tab and the home screen icon can keep separate saved data. Add the icon first, then do your setup inside the icon. If you already set up in Safari, use Export JSON there and Import JSON in the icon (section 6).

Android

1. Open the site in **Chrome**.
2. Tap the **three-dot menu** at the top right.
3. Tap **Add to Home screen** (some versions say **Install app**).
4. Confirm the name and tap **Add**.

Samsung Internet: open the menu, tap **Add page to**, then **Home screen**.

Desktop (Windows, Mac, Linux, Chromebook)

- **Simplest:** bookmark the page. Press **Ctrl+D** (Windows, Linux, Chromebook) or **Cmd+D** (Mac), and show your bookmarks bar.
- **Chrome or Edge:** if an install icon appears at the right end of the address bar, click it to open the site in its own window. If there is none, open the browser menu and look for **Install page as app** or **Create shortcut** (Edge: **Apps**, then **Install this site as an app**).
- **Safari on Mac:** choose **File**, then **Add to Dock**.

Whichever way you open it on a computer, your data lives in that one browser on that one computer. A bookmark in Chrome and a shortcut in Edge do not share data.

2. First-time setup (about five minutes)

Until this is done, figures are zero or guesses. Nothing calculates until you set your payday. The steps are the same on every device.

1. **Settings, then Pay.** Enter your **hourly rate**, your **take-home %**, and the **day of the week you are paid**. Take-home % is the share of gross pay you actually receive: divide net by gross on a recent payslip. It starts at 100, which just shows gross.
2. **Settings, then Your schedule.** Pick your shift pattern, or set the start time, end time and the days you work.
3. **Settings, then Union dues**, if dues come out of your check.
4. **Bills, then + Add bill** for each bill, with the day of the month it is due. Weekly bills go on the Weekly tab.
5. **Check Settings, then What your rules work out to.** It shows your pay rate, overtime rates and what a plain week pays. If those numbers look wrong, something above is wrong.

Then just use the **Clock In** button each shift.

3. Using it every day

The bar along the bottom switches between five pages. The app always opens on **Clock**.

Clocking in and out

- Open the app and tap the big green **Clock In** button when you start. Tap it again when you finish. The timer under it runs while you are on.
- **This week** (top) shows hours so far, split into Shift, 1.5x and 2x. **Next paycheck** shows what the week has earned *so far*, not a projection.
- **Today** shows the same three figures for today alone.

Working a holiday

- Tap **Holiday Clock In** (the small button under the timer) instead of Clock In. Every hour of that session is paid at 2x.
- If you are *off* on a paid holiday, do not use this. Mark the day instead (next section).

Forgot to clock in or out, or fixing a mistake

- Go to **Clock**, then the **Punches** tab.
- **+ Add a punch** takes a date, a start time and an end time. **Use my shift times** fills both from your schedule. An end time earlier than the start means the shift ran past midnight.
- Tap **Edit** or **Delete** on any punch in the list.

Days off

On the Punches tab, tap **PTO / Vacation / Holiday** and pick the date and type:

Type	How it is paid
Vacation	Paid in advance, so it does not pay on this check.
PTO	A full paid day.
Paid holiday	A full paid day.
Other	Paid or unpaid, a full day or part of one.

Manual Entry for Week (folded card on the Punches tab) overrides a whole week by hand. Use it when you know what a week paid but never clocked it. It **replaces** the punches for that week everywhere in the app.

Punches, manual entries and marked days hide themselves once their check has been paid. Nothing is deleted: hidden entries still count in every total and are in your backup. The button above each list brings older ones back ten at a time.

4. What each page tells you

Page	What it answers	Good to know
Clock	Am I clocked in, and what is this week worth so far?	Two tabs: Clock and Punches.
Earned	What has a given week actually earned?	Arrows move between weeks. **Jump to this week** returns. The **Earned** tab counts only what has happened; the **Projected** tab shows what the week should pay and does not move as you clock in.
PayCalc	What are the next few checks, after bills?	Tabs: Paychecks and Projection.
Bills	What goes out, and when?	Tabs: Monthly and Weekly. Includes a date range total.
Settings	The rules everything else is calculated from.	Appearance, schedule, pay, overtime, union dues, data.

Reading your paychecks

- Open **PayCalc**. Each row is one payday, tagged **logged**, **projected** or **manual entry**, with the bills due in that check's window and what is left over.
- **Tap a row** to open the breakdown: gross, overtime lines, net, union dues, one-time pay, the bills due, and what survives. Red is money out, green is money in.
- **Potential savings**, the strip at the bottom, is everything left over across every check shown. **Past weeks / Future weeks** at the top control how many checks are listed.
- **Projection** tab: set the overtime you expect in a normal week (1.5x and 2x hours) and any time off you expect. Weeks with real punches ignore these; weeks with a manual entry use that instead.
- **One-time pay** (advance vacation pay, a bonus) has its own tax field. Your take-home % is not applied to it.

Bills tools

- **Date range total**: pick two dates and see what falls between. The first shortcut is named after your payday (for example, **Next Tue to Tue**). Untick a bill to leave it out of the total.
- On a monthly bill, **Skip a month** leaves out one you have already paid or do not owe this time.

5. How the pay is worked out

- A **scheduled day** pays a flat daily base. Hours outside your shift window are overtime: **2 hours at 1.5x, then 2x**.
- A **day off** is overtime from the first minute: 8 hours at 1.5x, then 2x.
- The **last day of your time off** (the day before you are back) is **2x all day**. For a Monday to Friday schedule, that is Sunday.
- A **full week pays its flat base** whatever the hours. The daily base is that spread across your scheduled days.
- The **AWW premium** makes a short schedule whole: three twelves earns the same weekly base as five eights.
- **Union dues** come off the first check of each calendar month, worked out from the hourly rate alone (the shift premium is not counted).
- **Take-home %** is a flat estimate, not real withholding.

Change your rate and past checks keep the rate they were actually paid at. The current and future checks use the new one. Figures are rounded for display only.

6. Back up and move your data

Your data lives only in the browser on the device you use. Clearing that browser's site data erases it, and a different browser or device starts empty. **Settings, then Data** is the only backup tool.

Do this	Steps
Back up	Settings, Data, **Export JSON**. A file is saved or offered to you. Keep a copy somewhere safe (cloud drive, email to yourself).
Restore or move devices	On the new device, open the site, go to Settings, Data, **Import JSON**, and pick the file. Move the file between devices by email, a cloud drive or AirDrop.
Erase everything	Settings, Data, **Erase all data**. This cannot be undone, so export first.

Where the exported file lands. iPhone: choose Save to Files from the share sheet, or check the Files app. Android: usually the Downloads folder. Desktop: your browser's download folder. If you used an older web address for the app, that address holds its own data. Export there and import at paycalc.work.

7. Troubleshooting

Problem	What to try
Everything shows zero, or Pay says to set up	Open Settings, Pay, and set the **day you are paid**. Nothing calculates without it. Also check hourly rate and schedule.
My data is gone	You are probably in a different browser, in the home screen icon instead of Safari (or the reverse), on another device, or the site data was cleared. Go back to where you used it, or import your latest backup.
The page looks old after an update	Close the app fully and reopen it. On a phone browser, pull down to refresh. On desktop, hard refresh with Ctrl+Shift+R (Windows, Linux) or Cmd+Shift+R (Mac).
A shift that ran past midnight looks wrong	Edit the punch. An end time earlier than the start time means it ended the next day.
I forgot to clock out	Open Clock, Punches, tap **Edit** on the running punch, and enter the real out time.
Numbers do not match my payslip	Open Settings, **What your rules work out to**, and compare pay rate, overtime rates and a plain week against your payslip. Take-home % is only an estimate.
It does not work with no signal	The app is designed to keep working offline after it has loaded once, but this depends on your browser keeping its saved copy. Open it once with a connection first.
A security warning shows on the address	Use **https://** in front of the address. If it persists, tell whoever set up the site.

An estimate, not payroll. PayCalc gives estimates based on the rules you enter. It is not your employer's payroll system, and your actual pay can differ. Check it against your payslip.